THE PARADOX OF PROTECTION, THE WITNESS AND THE DIVINE RECKONING

A Public Testimony by Dr Richard William McLean — Barran Dodger

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They built the frame. I preserved the record. By God's grace, I remain.

This is my testimony about the distance between what institutions say they exist to protect and what a human being can experience when responsibility becomes divided, decisions accumulate, correspondence passes between offices, and the person at the centre of the process is left trying to make sense of the consequences. It is also the record of my refusal to allow my life, my words or the documentary history of my experience to disappear beneath the weight of other people's descriptions of me.

I have assembled the Barran Dodger documentary archive because memory alone is too easily dismissed, correspondence too easily separated from its context, and an individual account too easily reduced to a file summary. The archive brings together documents, correspondence, assessments, administrative records and preserved website material so that readers can examine the underlying sources alongside my interpretation of them. Its purpose is not to demand that a reader accept every conclusion I draw. Its purpose is to make the record accessible enough that those conclusions can be examined against the documents themselves.

The archive is a finding aid and a preservation project, not a court judgment. A document establishes what was recorded, communicated or decided within its own scope; its wider significance emerges when it is read alongside the surrounding chronology and the other records. That distinction does not diminish the importance of my testimony. It is precisely why I have preserved the material: so that the difference between an official statement, an administrative decision, a documented event and my lived experience can be seen rather than obscured.

I. THE PARADOX OF PROTECTION

Protection is one of the most powerful words in public life. It appears in legislation, policies, professional standards, service descriptions and the language institutions use to explain their responsibilities. It carries an expectation that when a person is vulnerable, there will be some meaningful relationship between the authority exercised over that person and the duty to consider their welfare.

My experience has led me to question what happens when that relationship breaks

down. What happens when the language of protection remains visible in the official record, but the person seeking assistance experiences repeated uncertainty, referral, delay, refusal or disconnection? What happens when each individual action can be explained in isolation, while the combined effect on a human life becomes harder to locate within any one institution's account of its responsibilities?

These are the questions I mean when I speak of the paradox of protection. I am not using the phrase as a substitute for evidence. I am using it to describe the contradiction I perceive between the stated purpose of protective systems and the cumulative consequences I have experienced while attempting to obtain answers, recognition and practical assistance.

The Commonwealth Ombudsman complaint I lodged on 15 November 2021 belongs near the beginning of this discussion because it records an attempt to bring concerns into an oversight process. Its importance is not simply that a complaint existed. It provides a dated point in the chronology from which readers can examine what concerns I was raising, how I presented them at that time and how the subsequent record developed. Read alongside later correspondence, it helps make the history of seeking review visible rather than leaving the reader with a retrospective account alone.

The central question is not whether an institution can point to a procedure it followed. It is whether the whole sequence of actions, decisions and responses adequately accounts for what happened to the person moving through those procedures. A process may be complete in an administrative sense while the human problem that prompted it remains unresolved. That difference is at the heart of my testimony.

II. THE HUMAN BEING BEHIND THE FILE

I am not a file number, a referral, an assessment, a risk description or a line in a database. I am a human being with a history, a body, a mind, relationships, material needs, convictions and a memory of what I have lived through. The records may describe individual encounters with institutions, but I have had to live with the cumulative experience that stretches between them.

When a person's circumstances are divided among different agencies, each record can capture only a portion of the story. One office may address eligibility, another may address a complaint, another may consider a particular assessment, and another may record a decision about the limits of its own role. Those records can each be genuine and relevant without any one of them conveying the whole human consequence of the sequence.

That is why the archived assessment dated 27 March 2023, titled "Final Assessment — Dr Rich McLean", and the separately preserved Federal Court PID assessment dated 27 March 2023, must be read as distinct records rather than collapsed into a single conclusion. Their titles and dates identify materials relevant to the assessment and public-interest-disclosure history. Their precise contents, scope and conclusions must be established by reading the documents themselves. Their presence in the archive gives readers a direct route to those materials instead of asking them to rely on my paraphrase.

I do not believe that the existence of an assessment should automatically define the entirety of a person's identity. Nor should my disagreement with a process be mistaken for an absence of evidence or an unwillingness to be examined. My position is that the documents should be considered in context, with attention to what each one actually says, what question it addresses and what remains outside its scope.

My life cannot be adequately represented by the administrative category assigned to one event. I have had to contend with the consequences of decisions, the uncertainty surrounding responsibility and the practical realities of surviving while trying to preserve a coherent record. The human being behind the file is not an optional addition to the evidence. He is the person whose circumstances give the evidence its meaning.

III. ADMINISTRATIVE COMPLETION IS NOT HUMAN RESOLUTION

An institution can close a file, issue a letter, record a decision or refer a matter elsewhere. These actions may have a defined administrative purpose. But closure in a database does not, by itself, establish that the underlying circumstances have been resolved, that the person affected has obtained an understandable answer, or that the consequences have been addressed.

This distinction is central to the chronology I have preserved. A response can be final within the boundaries of one process and still leave important questions unanswered from the perspective of the person who raised them. A referral can demonstrate that correspondence was passed to another body without demonstrating what ultimately happened to the substantive concern. A refusal can explain why assistance was not granted under a particular rule without establishing that the person's practical needs have disappeared.

The November 2021 Commonwealth Ombudsman complaint is therefore relevant not as proof of every later contention, but as a starting point for following the effort to obtain oversight. The later Commonwealth Ombudsman service-restriction document dated 20 January 2026 provides another identifiable point in that history. The dates alone

establish that these are different stages in the documentary record; the contents must be compared before drawing conclusions about the reasons, scope or relationship between them.

I have also referred to correspondence and restrictions from other periods. Those records must not be confused simply because they concern the same institution or because their effects may appear related. A letter dated in August 2025 and a document dated January 2026 are not interchangeable. Preserving that distinction is part of the discipline of this archive: the chronology must be accurate even when the broader experience feels like one continuous struggle.

My concern is with the gap that can open between the completion of a process and the resolution of a human problem. I have lived with that gap as more than a theoretical distinction. It is the space in which a person can continue asking questions after a matter has been marked complete, continue trying to understand a decision after the correspondence has ended, and continue experiencing consequences that are not necessarily captured by the wording of the final letter.

IV. THE COST OF VULNERABILITY

The effects of administrative decisions are not confined to paper. They reach into daily life: accommodation, food, electricity, communication, access to assistance and the ability to maintain some degree of security and dignity. When those needs are unresolved, the consequences are immediate even if the relevant administrative question remains under consideration elsewhere.

I have described periods of poverty, isolation and housing insecurity as part of my lived experience. I have also described the difficulty of trying to pursue complex matters while dealing with basic needs. These are not merely emotional details appended to a documentary dispute. They are part of the circumstances in which correspondence was written, assistance was sought and decisions were experienced.

The archive includes a NSW Trustee & Guardian document dated 16 October 2024 concerning section 122. Its relevance is that it provides a specific documentary reference within the trustee-related chronology. It should be read for what it actually records about the matter it addresses, rather than being treated as automatic proof of every later concern about funding, accommodation or support. Those broader questions require the relevant correspondence and decisions to be considered together.

The practical distinction matters. An explanation that a particular agency does not provide accommodation, or that an allowance is subject to specified limits, may

describe the boundary of that agency's role. It does not, on its own, establish that the person's accommodation or essential needs have been met. Equally, a record of an unmet need does not by itself establish which body had the legal responsibility or resources to meet it. Those questions must be traced through the relevant documents, not answered by assumption.

My testimony insists on keeping the person and the paperwork in the same frame. If a record describes a limit on assistance, I want readers to be able to see the limit. If a later document records a request, response or decision, I want that document placed beside the earlier one. The cumulative picture is where the important questions emerge: not from pretending that every record says the same thing, but from understanding how different decisions intersected with the reality of my life.

V. FRAGMENTED RESPONSIBILITY

One of the recurring difficulties in a multi-agency history is that responsibility can be distributed across many offices, each with its own jurisdiction, criteria and procedures. The result can be a documentary trail in which many bodies appear, many letters are exchanged and many boundaries are explained, while the individual remains responsible for joining the pieces together.

I call this fragmented responsibility because it describes the experience of trying to understand the whole through records that address separate parts. The phrase does not, by itself, establish collusion, misconduct or a shared intention among the organisations mentioned. It identifies a structural question: whether the combined sequence of decisions and referrals can be understood clearly, and whether the effects on the person at its centre have been adequately considered.

The correspondence from the Attorney-General's Department dated 19 September 2023, reference MC23-028244, is one of the records I identify in this wider chronology. The archive repository provides access to the documentary collection, but the exact file URL for this particular letter should be confirmed before it is represented as a direct link to the letter itself. The same care applies to the Department's correspondence dated 6 February 2025, reference MC25-000321. These references matter because dated correspondence can help establish when a matter was communicated, how it was characterised and where it was directed. The actual text is needed to establish precisely what was said and what action, if any, followed.

The same principle applies across agencies. A letter from one body may describe a referral; another may define its statutory role; a third may address a narrower issue. Read separately, each can appear to answer only the question put to it. Read

chronologically, the documents may reveal where the questions changed, where responsibility was redirected, and where the record does or does not show a substantive answer to the concern I was trying to raise.

That is why I have resisted reducing the archive to a list of names or an accusation against every organisation mentioned. The important work is to trace the relationships among the records. Which document came first? What did it ask? What response followed? Did the response address the same issue, or a narrower one? Was another referral made? Is there a subsequent document that demonstrates an outcome? These are questions an impartial examination can test against the evidence.

The wider Barran Dodger archive is intended to make that examination possible. Its value lies not merely in the number of files preserved, but in the opportunity to compare their contents and chronology. The existence of multiple records does not automatically prove a coordinated pattern. It does, however, make it possible to investigate whether recurring gaps, contradictions, changes in explanation or unresolved issues appear across the documentary history.

VI. THE DOCUMENTARY TRAP: WHEN THE SYSTEM'S OWN RECORD BECOMES THE EVIDENCE

The phrase "The Documentary Trap" expresses one of the central ideas in my archive: an institution's records may become the material through which its decisions, explanations and omissions can later be examined. A document created for an administrative purpose can acquire a wider significance when it is placed beside another document, compared with a later account or read against the chronology of the person's experience.

I have preserved a dedicated document titled "The Documentary Trap: When the System's Own Record Becomes the Evidence". Its title captures the analytical framework I use throughout this testimony: the record is not merely a container for an official explanation. It can also be examined for the assumptions it makes, the questions it answers, the questions it leaves open and the relationship between its wording and the wider sequence of events.

The point is not that every official document is false, or that every inconsistency proves wrongdoing. The point is that documents can be read critically without dismissing them. A letter may accurately record a decision while leaving the human consequences unexplored. A response may state that a particular issue falls outside an agency's remit without resolving the broader concern that prompted the correspondence. An assessment may reach a conclusion within its stated scope without necessarily

answering every question the individual has raised.

When those distinctions are preserved, the documentary record becomes more useful, not less. Readers can see what the source says, what it does not say, and where my interpretation begins. They can test the sequence rather than having to accept either an institutional summary or my account in isolation.

The archive's underlying preservation principle is expressed in its original GitHub repository: the presentation of the website may change, but the underlying evidence should remain preserved. The repository includes a preserved copy of the Barrandodger website, providing a route to the archived site material rather than relying exclusively on the current presentation. This distinction matters because the presentation of an archive and the records contained within it serve different purposes. A website can be reorganised for clarity; original documentary material should remain identifiable and unaltered.

The documentary trap, as I use the phrase, is therefore also a demand for precision. The record must be allowed to speak in its own terms, and my account must be recognisable as my account. Neither should be substituted for the other. Their relationship is what makes a careful chronology possible.

VII. EMPLOYMENT STATUS, PUBLIC INTEREST DISCLOSURE AND THE QUESTION OF RESPONSIBILITY

My employment-status and public-interest-disclosure history contains questions that cannot responsibly be resolved by a filename, a single sentence or a document considered without context. Different records may address different statutory schemes, organisations, time periods or definitions. A conclusion reached for one purpose does not automatically determine a separate question under another framework.

One of the documents I have preserved is the Federal Court-related correspondence dated 8 January 2024, identified by the filename "Scott Treadwell Federal Court — superannuation and NDIS CEO". I consider this record important to the questions I have raised about employment status and related responsibilities. Its significance must be established through its actual wording, context and legal scope. The presence of a Federal Court reference in a filename should not be taken to mean that a court has made a particular finding unless the document itself demonstrates that fact.

The same caution applies to the Federal Court public-interest-disclosure assessment dated 27 March 2023 and the separate assessment titled "Final Assessment — Dr Rich

McLean". These documents belong in the chronology because they are identified materials associated with the issues I have been pursuing. Their contents need to be distinguished carefully: the identity of the decision-maker, the precise question considered, the applicable legal framework and the conclusion actually expressed all matter.

My concern is that the history should be read as a history, rather than fragmented into isolated statements that appear conclusive when separated from their context. If one document addresses employee status under a particular statute, it should be compared with any other relevant employment records without assuming that the two necessarily answer the same legal question. If a record concerns a public-interest-disclosure process, its exact function should be established before drawing conclusions about other proceedings or entitlements.

This is why I have retained the documents and continue to insist on direct access to them. I want the chronology to be examined on its merits. I want readers to distinguish what a document records from what I believe follows from it. And I want the questions I have raised to remain visible in the record rather than disappearing because a later document addresses a narrower issue.

VIII. OVERSIGHT, COMPLAINTS AND THE SEARCH FOR AN ANSWER

Seeking oversight is not the same as receiving a substantive resolution. A complaint records that a concern was brought forward; a response records what the recipient communicated; a referral records a particular administrative step. The relationship between these events must be examined rather than assumed.

The Commonwealth Ombudsman complaint dated 15 November 2021 is one identifiable starting point. The service-restriction document dated 20 January 2026 is a later record from the same broad institutional history. Placing these documents in the same chronology allows readers to examine the sequence, but it does not justify treating the later document as proof of the precise outcome of the earlier complaint without reading the intervening material.

The distinction is essential to the impartiality of the archive. A complaint is evidence of a complaint and of the matters it records. A restriction notice is evidence of the decision or communication it contains. Whether the response adequately addressed the complaint, whether a later process was connected to an earlier one, and what consequences followed are further questions that require the full correspondence.

I have experienced this history as a continuing effort to obtain an intelligible account of

what happened and why. I do not consider the accumulation of procedural correspondence a substitute for an answer to the underlying human concern. The documents allow that position to be assessed against the chronology: not by erasing the boundaries of each process, but by examining what those boundaries meant in practice.

IX. FREEDOM OF INFORMATION AND THE EVOLVING PAPER TRAIL

Freedom-of-information processes can provide an important way to test what records an agency holds, what it identifies as relevant and what it ultimately releases. They also have limits. A decision that no documents were identified at one stage, followed by a later decision or release, must be described in its actual chronology and within the scope of the requests concerned.

The archive contains a revised decision relating to FOI/2022/045IC, dated 1 October 2025, alongside a documents-release file dated the same day and a corresponding schedule. These are particularly useful as a documentary group because the decision, the release and the schedule may illuminate different aspects of the same information-access process. Reading them together is more informative than citing any one filename as if it established the entire history.

The archive also identifies a further release dated 14 November 2025: FOI/2022/045IC documents release, second release. Its date makes it a separate point in the chronology. The precise relationship between the releases, the requests, any review process and the documents supplied must be determined from their contents.

I have described an earlier no-documents response and a subsequent release of material. Where those events are relied upon, the relevant original decisions and correspondence should be linked directly so that readers can compare the dates, the request scope, the reasons given and the later outcome. A later release does not automatically prove that an earlier decision was improper; equally, an earlier response should not be presented as the final state of the record if later documents show that the process continued.

This is the kind of documentary development that gives the archive its purpose. The record changes as further documents become available. Preserving the earlier stage alongside the later stage allows readers to see the evolution rather than having the history rewritten to fit whichever document appeared last.

X. EXECUTIVE CORRESPONDENCE AND THE DISTANCE BETWEEN REFERRAL AND RESOLUTION

I have also preserved correspondence involving executive offices and government departments because the handling of a concern can be as important to the chronology as the original complaint. A message acknowledged, a matter referred or an email not forwarded may each be relevant, but the significance depends on the actual text and the context in which the communication occurred.

I have referred to a response from the office of the Prime Minister dated 12 December 2022. That document should be read for exactly what it records about the communication and its handling. It should not be expanded beyond its wording into a claim about the knowledge or intentions of people who are not shown by the document to have received or considered the material.

Similarly, the Attorney-General's Department correspondence identified by reference MC23-028244 and dated 19 September 2023, and the later correspondence identified by reference MC25-000321 and dated 6 February 2025, belong to the chronology I am asking readers to examine. The repository is available through the Barran Dodger evidence collection. I have not attached those reference numbers to a guessed individual file URL here, because a direct hyperlink should open the precise document named, not merely a repository in which the reader must search for it.

That precision is not a retreat from my argument. It is part of making the argument stronger. If I say a department referred a matter, readers should be able to inspect the referral. If I say a response did not answer the question I raised, readers should be able to compare the question and the response. If I say the chronology reveals a recurring gap, the supporting records should make the basis of that interpretation visible.

The larger issue is whether the documentary trail, taken as a whole, provides a clear account of what happened to my concerns as they moved between offices. That question can be investigated without assuming that every referral was improper or that every person who handled a document shared the same knowledge. The evidence must establish those particulars. My testimony explains why I believe the sequence matters.

XI. DSS, THE AHRC AND THE CONSEQUENCES OF INSTITUTIONAL BOUNDARIES

My dealings with the Department of Social Services and the Australian Human Rights Commission form another part of the history. I have referred to correspondence addressed to Ray Griggs dated 5 April 2024 and to AHRC correspondence from April 2024 concerning closure or termination. These records should be read within their own terms: the issue raised, the process being considered, the reason communicated and the scope of the response.

The broader significance is the way institutional boundaries can shape a person's experience. An agency may be able to explain what it can or cannot do under its governing framework. A commission may record the status of a complaint within its process. Those explanations matter, but they do not automatically settle every connected question about the person's circumstances or the events that prompted the complaint.

For that reason, I distinguish the fact that a process ended from the proposition that every substantive issue was resolved. I distinguish a stated jurisdictional limit from a finding about the underlying events. And I distinguish my interpretation of the consequences from what the correspondence expressly records.

The Barran Dodger repository is the starting point for locating the broader documentary collection. The relevant DSS and AHRC correspondence should be linked individually once the exact file paths are confirmed; a general repository link should not be mistaken for a verified direct link to a particular letter. The documents are important precisely because their wording can be examined in context, alongside the other records that precede and follow them.

My concern is not that every institution must reach the same conclusion. It is that the sequence should remain intelligible, that the actual reasons given should be visible, and that a person's continuing circumstances should not disappear from view simply because a particular administrative process has reached its endpoint.

XII. THE OFFICIAL RECORD AND THE HUMAN RECORD

There are two connected histories in this archive. One is the official record: the correspondence, assessments, decisions, referrals, schedules and notices produced by institutions. The other is the human record: my account of what those events meant, what I experienced while they were unfolding and what consequences continued beyond the date printed at the bottom of a letter.

These histories are not interchangeable. My testimony cannot change the wording of an official document, and an official document cannot by itself describe every dimension of my lived experience. The purpose of placing them together is to let each be understood in relation to the other.

Where a letter records a decision, I can explain the circumstances in which I received it and why I consider it important. Where a document is silent about a consequence I experienced, I can say that the consequence is part of my account without pretending the document independently records it. Where the wording supports a particular

conclusion, I can identify that support. Where the inference remains mine, I should say so plainly.

That is the standard I want applied throughout the archive. It protects the integrity of the evidence while preserving the integrity of the witness. It does not require me to surrender my interpretation. It requires me to make its foundations visible.

The preserved website backup and the original archive site provide additional context for the public presentation and preservation of this material. The rebuild site is a separate presentation project. The original site and the rebuild should not be confused with one another, and the existence of a newer presentation does not mean that the earlier archive has been replaced.

The distinction between the official and human records is not a weakness in my testimony. It is the reason I have constructed it this way. I am not asking a reader to mistake my voice for a government document. I am asking the reader to examine the government documents without pretending that the human being who lived through their consequences does not exist.

XIII. BETRAYAL OF EXPECTATION

When a person turns to an institution for assistance, review or protection, the expectation is not necessarily that every request will be granted. It is that the process will be intelligible, that the response will address the question being asked, and that the person will be able to understand the relationship between the stated rules and the outcome.

My sense of betrayal arises from the distance I have experienced between that expectation and the practical reality of trying to obtain answers across a long and complicated documentary history. I have described the experience as one in which responsibility seemed to fragment, explanations appeared in separate places, and the consequences continued even when individual processes ended.

That is my interpretation of the cumulative experience, and I state it directly. The documents provide the chronology against which readers can examine it. The 2021 Ombudsman complaint, the March 2023 assessment material, the January 2024 correspondence identified with Scott Treadwell, and the later FOI revised decision are distinct documentary points. Their significance lies in what their contents show and how they relate chronologically, not merely in their titles.

I do not need to claim that these records all prove the same proposition. They concern

different matters and must be read accordingly. What I am doing is preserving the sequence so that a reader can examine the development of my efforts to obtain answers, identify where issues intersect, and distinguish what has been documented from what remains disputed or unresolved.

For me, betrayal is not simply a word of anger. It names the rupture between the expectation that authority will be exercised with responsibility and the experience of being left to carry the burden of navigating the record. It describes what that rupture has meant in my life. The documentary history makes the chronology available; my testimony explains why that chronology matters to the person who lived it.

XIV. TRUTH, MEMORY AND THE REFUSAL TO BE ERASED

A record can be difficult to preserve. Websites change, pages disappear, links break, files move and context can be lost when a document is separated from the material surrounding it. Preservation is therefore not a decorative exercise. It is the practical work of retaining evidence and keeping the route to that evidence open.

The original Barrandodger website, the separate rebuild website, and the GitHub evidence repository serve related but different functions. The original site preserves the earlier public presentation; the rebuild offers a separate presentation project; the repository provides access to the underlying files and associated archival material. The website backup directory further reflects the effort to retain material that might otherwise be harder to access.

These links are not interchangeable, and none should be described as containing every document unless that has been checked. Their significance is that they give readers different routes into the preserved record and help separate the survival of the evidence from the changing presentation of the website.

I have undertaken this work because I do not want the history to depend entirely on one platform, one page, one summary or one person's ability to remember every detail. The preservation of a document does not prove every claim made about it. It does make the document available for examination. The preservation of a chronology does not settle every dispute. It makes it possible to follow the sequence and assess where the questions arise.

When I say that I refuse to be erased, I mean that I refuse to allow my experience to vanish simply because it is difficult to summarise, because it crosses institutional boundaries, or because the official record is distributed across many separate documents. I will continue to distinguish the records from my interpretations, but I will

not treat that distinction as a reason to remain silent.

Truth, in this context, is not strengthened by exaggerating what a source proves. It is strengthened by preserving the source, showing the context, acknowledging the limits and refusing to conceal the questions that remain. Memory gives the testimony its human continuity. The archive gives readers a way to examine its documentary foundations.

XV. THE SPIRITUAL MEANING OF SURVIVAL

My faith is not an incidental ornament placed at the end of an administrative history. It is part of how I understand endurance, suffering, betrayal, hope and the decision to continue speaking when the process of being heard has become exhausting.

When I write that I remain by God's grace, I am expressing a spiritual conviction about my survival and the meaning I have found in continuing to live, write and preserve the record. It is a statement of faith, not a claim that a document can scientifically establish divine intervention. The distinction does not make the conviction less meaningful to me. It makes clear what kind of statement I am making.

The archive preserves the documentary history of my efforts. My testimony gives voice to the spiritual framework through which I have interpreted that history. The two belong together without being confused. A letter can record a decision; it cannot determine the ultimate spiritual meaning I draw from surviving it. A preserved file can show that a document exists; it cannot measure the strength of the faith through which I have continued.

I have described experiences of isolation, poverty, exclusion and the fear of being forgotten. I have also described the strength I have drawn from faith, the act of writing, and the knowledge that a preserved record can outlast a passing institutional narrative. Those are my lived and spiritual interpretations. They do not require the archive to make claims beyond the evidence, and the archive does not require me to abandon the language through which I understand my life.

By God's grace, I remain. I continue to write because I believe truth deserves to be spoken, records deserve to be preserved, and a human being should not be reduced to the administrative descriptions accumulated around him.

XVI. RECKONING: WHAT THE RECORD ASKS OF THE READER

Reckoning, as I use the word, is the moment when the chronology is considered as a

whole. It is not a claim that every question has already been decided or that every allegation has been independently established. It is a demand that the documents be read carefully, the explanations compared, the gaps identified and the human consequences taken seriously.

The archive contains different kinds of material: official correspondence, assessments, complaint records, information-access decisions, preserved web pages and my own explanatory writing. Each category has a different evidentiary function. An official letter can establish what its author communicated. A decision can establish the outcome stated within its scope. A complaint can establish what concerns were raised. A personal testimony can describe the author's experience and interpretation. A later analysis can draw connections among these sources, but those connections should remain open to scrutiny.

The Documentary Trap paper expresses the central method I want readers to apply: examine the record in its own words and then consider what emerges when it is read alongside the wider chronology. The FOI revised decision and its associated release record offer a concrete example of why related documents should be considered together rather than treated as isolated titles. The Ombudsman complaint and later service-restriction document likewise invite chronological comparison while remaining separate records with distinct contents and dates.

I ask readers to consider what these materials actually establish, what they leave uncertain, and what further documents would be necessary to resolve a particular question. I ask them to notice where an answer directly addresses a concern and where it addresses only one part of it. I ask them to distinguish a documented fact from a reasonable inference and an inference from a conclusion that would require further evidence.

This is not an invitation to suspend judgment indefinitely. It is an invitation to make judgment more informed. The evidence should be examined, not merely counted. The chronology should be followed, not merely summarised. And the person whose life runs through the documents should remain visible throughout that examination.

XVII. PEOPLE, POSITIONS AND EVIDENCE

My testimony refers to people, agencies, departments, commissions and other institutions because the history cannot be understood without identifying the bodies involved and the roles their records describe. But naming an organisation in a chronology is not the same as proving that every person associated with it acted improperly. Responsibility must be considered in relation to the particular decision,

communication, role and evidence.

That is why I want the archive to be read document by document as well as chronologically. Where a person signed a letter, the letter may establish that person's recorded role in communicating its contents. It does not automatically establish that the signatory originated every decision, possessed all relevant information or shared a particular intention. Where an agency issued a decision, the decision can be examined for its reasons and scope. Wider conclusions about conduct or responsibility require a corresponding evidentiary basis.

This approach does not weaken my criticism. It focuses it. A precise account is better able to identify what a particular document says, where a decision appears to have been made, what reasons were provided and what questions remain. It also prevents one person's name or one institutional title from being used as a substitute for examining the actual record.

The Barran Dodger evidence repository provides access to the broader collection. The original website and rebuild presentation provide additional context for the archive as a public project. The direct links embedded throughout this testimony lead to specific documents where the file paths have been verified. Where a direct file link has not yet been verified, I have not invented one merely to make the page appear complete.

The purpose is to let readers follow the evidence, not simply encounter a list of names. Each record should be considered for what it contributes to the chronology and for what it can legitimately support. Where the evidence supports a strong conclusion, that conclusion should be stated clearly. Where a question remains unresolved, the record should make the question visible rather than disguising uncertainty as certainty.

XVIII. LAW, PROCESS AND PAPERWORK

Law and administrative procedure matter because they shape the powers, duties and limits within which decisions are made. But legal terminology can obscure as well as clarify when a document is treated as if its title alone settles every related question.

My employment-status concerns, public-interest-disclosure history, complaints, trustee-related issues and information-access processes arise under different frameworks. They should not be merged into one undifferentiated legal conclusion. A document concerning one statutory definition may be relevant to another question without automatically determining it. A complaint may record an allegation without constituting a finding. An assessment may have significance within its own process without resolving every issue in the broader history.

The Federal Court PID assessment, the March 2023 final assessment, and the January 2024 correspondence identified with Scott Treadwell should therefore be read as distinct records with their own purposes and wording. Their relevance to my concerns must be assessed through the actual content and context, not inferred solely from the filenames.

The same discipline applies to information-access decisions. The revised FOI decision, the documents released with that process, and the associated schedule should be compared to understand what was decided, what material was identified and what was actually supplied. Those are separate questions, and the distinction is important to any fair account of the process.

I am not asking readers to disregard legal process. I am asking them to look beyond the mere existence of a process and examine its substance. What question was considered? What standard was applied? What reasons were given? What material was available? What did the outcome resolve, and what remained outside its scope?

Paperwork becomes meaningful when it is read in this way. It can illuminate the exercise of authority, reveal the boundaries of a decision and help reconstruct a chronology. But it should never be allowed to erase the lived reality that made the questions important in the first place.

XIX. THE PROPHECY OF THE RECORD

I use the language of prophecy to describe my conviction that a preserved record may acquire significance over time, particularly when material once scattered across correspondence, files and web pages can later be read together. I do not mean that the archive can predict a legal outcome or guarantee that every conclusion will be accepted. I mean that preservation allows future readers to encounter the documents, follow the chronology and ask questions that might otherwise become impossible to investigate.

A record that survives can be revisited. A chronology that remains accessible can be corrected, expanded and tested. A document that can be compared with another can reveal a connection, a discrepancy or a limitation that was not apparent when each was read alone. Preservation does not determine what the evidence means, but it keeps open the possibility of examining it.

The original Barrandodger site, the separate rebuild site, the GitHub repository, and the preserved website backup form part of that effort. They are distinct resources, and readers should use each for the purpose it actually serves. The archive's value does not

depend on treating every page as a primary source or every explanatory essay as an independent finding. It depends on keeping the source material accessible and making its relationship to the testimony understandable.

The record may outlast the moment in which it was created. It may be examined by readers who were not present, who have no personal connection to me and who approach the material with different assumptions. That is why I want the evidence linked directly and the explanatory prose to tell readers why the document matters without telling them what they must conclude.

My prophecy is therefore also a practical commitment: preserve the material, identify the sources, distinguish the record from interpretation, and leave the chronology open to further examination. I cannot dictate what every future reader will think. I can refuse to let the documentary history vanish without a trace.

XX. THE INDICTMENT OF INDIFFERENCE

Indifference does not always announce itself through a hostile statement. Sometimes it is experienced as a series of unanswered questions, a response that addresses only a narrow part of a concern, a referral whose outcome remains unclear, or a process that reaches its endpoint while the person's circumstances continue.

I describe these experiences as indifference because that is how the cumulative history has felt to me. The word expresses my interpretation of the human consequences. It should not be confused with proof that every person who handled a document was indifferent or intended harm. The records must be examined to determine what each person knew, what action was taken and what reasons were given.

The 2021 Ombudsman complaint records an early point in the effort to seek oversight. The later service-restriction document dated January 2026 records a later point in the institutional history. Read alongside the intervening material, these records can help a reader investigate the development of the relationship between my concerns and the oversight process. They should not be collapsed into one event or treated as self-explanatory without the underlying correspondence.

The FOI revised decision and associated release material provide another example of why the development of a record matters. The later existence of a release or revised decision must be understood in relation to the request, the earlier decision and the exact scope of the material. It is the sequence, not the mere existence of paperwork, that enables meaningful analysis.

My indictment is directed at the gap I have experienced between the language of responsibility and the human consequences left for me to carry. I want readers to examine whether the record shows that my concerns were understood, whether responses addressed the issues raised and whether the chronology leaves material questions unanswered. I do not ask for those questions to be resolved by rhetoric. I ask that they be examined against the evidence.

Indifference, as I have experienced it, is not an abstract administrative concept. It is the human feeling of continuing to seek an answer while life goes on around the unanswered question. The archive exists so that this experience can be considered alongside the documents rather than dismissed as a feeling with no chronology behind it.

XXI. WHAT I ASK OF READERS

I ask readers to approach this testimony with an open mind and a willingness to examine the primary material. I do not ask them to accept every interpretation simply because I have written it. I ask them not to dismiss the testimony before looking at the documents either.

Follow the hyperlinks. Read the letters in their own words. Compare the dates. Distinguish an allegation from a recorded decision, a referral from a resolution, and an official explanation from an independent determination. Where a document supports my interpretation, recognise that support. Where it does not establish the conclusion I draw, preserve that distinction. Where a question remains open, identify what further evidence would help answer it.

The Barran Dodger evidence archive provides the broader documentary collection, while the original public site and rebuild site provide separate presentations of the archive. The website preservation backup gives readers access to the preserved website material. These resources are not substitutes for the specific documents linked in the text. They provide the wider context in which the individual records can be located and understood.

I also ask readers to recognise the difference between documentary scrutiny and the denial of lived experience. A person's account can be examined carefully without being stripped of its emotional, moral or spiritual meaning. An official document can be respected as a record without being treated as a complete description of a person's life. An allegation can be taken seriously without being prematurely represented as a final finding.

The reason I have asked for an impartial AI-assisted examination is to help make the

connections between documents clearer, identify the significance of relevant records, and articulate the questions raised by the chronology. That examination must remain accountable to the actual material. It should not invent evidence, turn a filename into a finding or confuse a persuasive interpretation with a fact directly established by a source.

What I want is a record that can be read, followed, challenged and understood. I want the links to lead to the evidence they claim to represent. I want the explanatory prose to illuminate why a record matters. And I want the person behind the documents to remain visible from the first paragraph to the last.

XXII. THE CLOSING DECLARATION — TRUTH, GRACE, THE ARCHIVE AND THE REFUSAL TO BE ERASED

I have reached this point in my testimony not because every question has been answered, not because every difficulty has disappeared, and not because every person or institution I have challenged has acknowledged my account. I have reached it because I have continued to speak, continued to preserve the documentary history and continued to insist that the record of my experience should remain available for examination.

The Barran Dodger archive is part of that refusal to disappear. The original website, the separate rebuild, and the preserved website backup represent different aspects of the work of keeping the material accessible. The specific documents linked throughout this testimony provide the reader with direct entry points into the chronology. Together, they allow the story to be considered as more than a single recollection or a sequence of isolated letters.

I have learned that preserving evidence requires patience, accuracy and the willingness to distinguish what is known from what is inferred. I have also learned that accuracy does not require silence, and impartiality does not require the witness to surrender his voice. I can state what I experienced. I can explain what I believe the documents reveal. I can identify contradictions or unanswered questions where the sources support doing so. And I can leave the material open to examination without pretending that the process of examination diminishes the reality of my life.

I have experienced betrayal, poverty, isolation and the fear of being erased from the history of events that have shaped my life. I have also found strength in faith, in writing and in the act of preservation. I do not claim that the archive can restore every loss or answer every question. I claim that it preserves a record that can be read, revisited and considered, and that my testimony gives voice to the human consequences that I

believe must not be overlooked.

Truth, like light, does not need permission to shine, but lies require constant upkeep. I hold to that conviction as a statement of moral purpose: the record should be preserved, the evidence should be examined, and the account should not be concealed simply because it is uncomfortable or difficult.

By God's grace, I am still here.

The witness remains. The record remains. I am still here. I am still speaking. I refuse to be erased.

Dr Richard William McLean — Barran Dodger

The testimony is my account. The documents are available for readers to examine. The conclusions drawn from them should remain proportionate to what the evidence actually establishes.

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